

Male Cat Post Neutering Care — Action Checklist

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FIRST 72 HOURS MONITORING

- ☐ **First 72 Hours Monitoring:** Keep your cat in a small, confined room with dim lighting for the first 12 hours while he recovers from general anesthesia and the disorienting effects wear off.
- ☐ **First 72 Hours Monitoring:** Confirm your cat has eaten something by the 48-hour mark after surgery, because complete lack of appetite at this point warrants a call to your vet to rule out complications.
- ☐ **First 72 Hours Monitoring:** Examine the incision on day 3 to verify it appears normal with mild redness around the edges, slight puffiness, and small dried blood spots on closed sutures.
- ☐ **First 72 Hours Monitoring:** Understand that grogginess, hiding, shivering, not eating, and meowing without other symptoms in the first 12 hours is completely normal post-anesthesia behavior.

CONE MANAGEMENT

- ☐ **Cone Management:** Ensure the cone fits with exactly two fingers of space between it and your cat's neck to prevent chafing while blocking access to the incision.
- ☐ **Cone Management:** Elevate the food bowl on a stack of books or small platform so your cat can eat without the cone rim hitting the bowl and blocking access.
- ☐ **Cone Management:** Switch to wet food on a flat plate instead of a deep bowl to make eating easier since the cone opening makes standard bowls difficult to access.
- ☐ **Cone Management:** Remove the cone only during direct meal supervision with your eyes on the cat at all times, then put the cone back on immediately after eating finishes.

WHEN TO CALL THE VET

- ☐ **When to Call the Vet:** Call your vet immediately if you notice any oozing, discharge, or foul-smelling fluid coming from the incision after the first 24 hours of recovery.
 - ☐ **When to Call the Vet:** Contact your vet if the incision becomes hot to the touch or if swelling visibly worsens after day 3, as increasing inflammation signals possible infection.
 - ☐ **When to Call the Vet:** Call your vet right away if you see gaps in the incision line or bleeding that continues or restarts after the initial post-surgery scabbing period.
 - ☐ **When to Call the Vet:** Reach out to your vet if your cat shows severe pain signals like constant crying and whimpering combined with other concerning symptoms, not just disorientation.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.